

Lab: This lab helps in evaluating potential drugs that will work against deadly diseases such as anthrax, smallpox, Ebola haemorrhagic fever, SARS, malaria, botulism, plague, and avian flu, which have affected many people in the recent past: several developing countries have had to take corrective steps against diseases such as SARS, anthrax, and avian flu. Africa, India, Korea, Indonesia, and many other regions urgently need to find a cure for infectious diseases such as avian flu.

The project is sponsored by a non-profit organisation called The Rothberg Institute for Childhood Diseases, based in Connecticut, USA.
[www.d2ol.com/pathogens.html]

National Foundation For Cancer Research

The Screensaver-Lifesaver Project at the NCFR Center for Computational Drug Discovery at Oxford University is a unique program to rapidly screen billions of molecules, each with the possibility of becoming a drug that cures cancer. The project partners are the NCFR,

University of Oxford, United Devices Inc., Intel, and Microsoft.
[www.nfcr.org/Default.aspx?tabid=274]

Grid.org

This is a grid computing platform and test bed that runs distributed computing projects such as the United Devices Cancer Research Project, which looks for potential candidate drugs for the treatment of cancer.

[www.grid.org/projects/cancer]

India is in 46th position amongst 236 countries, in terms of participation in such projects, according to the statistics available at BOINCstats.com. Our country is rapidly growing in the IT sphere and has the potential to contribute much more.

Make A Difference!

The world, as you know all too well, faces problems relating to diseases, the environment, climate, and other things. All countries except possibly the most poverty-stricken are trying their best to research and find solutions.

To do your bit, you don't

have to take out banners and roam the streets; nor will you need to accost people for donations. All you have to do is participate in any of the projects mentioned above, and any others you may come along when browsing the sites!

Participation in non-profit scientific research projects is one workable way ahead for humanitarian welfare. It doesn't require your presence, and won't cost you anything more than a slightly larger electricity bill—which you pay anyway by leaving your computer idle. This is, of course, assuming your Internet connection is always on.

We're hoping that after having read this article, you'll participate in one of the above projects—to make this world a better place!

Companies, too, can take a conscious decision to donate CPU time of company computers, and consider the increased electric bill as their contribution to charity... nay, *humanity!* ■

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